ZIMBABWE PROVISIONAL THEORY

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based on the highway code's rules and regulations

INTRODUCTION





- The general rule of the highway code is always keep left when driving on Zimbabwean roads and overtake on the right.
- When it comes to traffic Zimbabwe is known as animal or cattle country
- The highway code states that you should assist the elderly , children and the disabled where ever possible when there are on the road.
- When driving on Zimbabwean roads and you feel sleepy the law requires you to stay off the road and rest
- Road test in Zimbabwe are done using manual cars except if you have a disability you use automatic cars
- The Zimbabwe road traffic system is made up of four elements which are

i) Road users

ii) Traffic environment

iii) Vehicles

iv) Road signs and signals

ROAD USERS

i) Cyclist – must wear helmet always

- Must not carry luggage that exceeding 40 kgs
- A person under 16 is not allowed to carry a passenger
- Always keep both you feet on the pedals
- Cyclist are to ride in a single file when ever they are on roads
- If you are a driver the law forbids you to never overtake a cyclist whenever you are turning to the left
- A pedal cyclist can not carry a fire extinguisher for there is no room for it

II) Animal drawn wagons – these vehicles must have reins and a leader at all times for they are animals and animal behavior is unpredictable

- If you are a motorist you must Slow down and pass on the safest side or overtake it with which ever side which is safe to do so
- If you see an animal drawn wagon facing you in the same lane you must stop at a sufficient distance to avoid accident

iii) Pedestrians – they must use the right side of the road , if there is a suitable verge they must use it.

- When crossing they must not cross in front of the vehicle but to wait for the vehicle to leave
- At a pedestrian cross every driver must Wait patiently and proceed when appropriate, Pay special attention to pedestrians.
- Pedestrians have the right of way on pedestrian crossings or at a controlled intersections however the law says pedestrians should also yield to vehicle traffic when ever crossing the road

REQUIREMENTS TO DRIVE ON ZIMBABWEAN ROADS

AGE	CLASS
16 years	4 & 3
18 years	2,4&5
25 years	1,2,4,5

For class 1 you must have the following

- **5 years of driving experience**
- **Defensive driving certificate (DDC) valid for 48 months**
- **Medical fitness certificate (12 months)**
- **On class 1 passengers are the most important thing on a bus**

For class 2

- **A heavy vehicle has a net mass of 2300 kgs and above**
- **A leaners truck must have a minimum weight of 5000kgs and a length of 7m**
- **A heavy vehicle must not draw more than 3 trailers and if it is drawing trailers it must have safety chains fitted on them**
- **At a rail level crossing with open booms a heavy vehicle driver should stop but for light motor vehicle they must slow down , look both sides and proceed if its clear**
- **A motor vehicle towing two trailers should carry 6 breakdown triangles**
- **When towing caravan trailers safest mirrors to use are Extended arm side mirrors**

For taxis

- **You must be 21**
- **5 years of driving**
- **Medical fitness certificate**
- **Holder of either class 2 or 4 drivers license**

For motor cyclist class 3

- **A motor cycle only caries 1 passenger and when it has a side car it carries 2 passengers only**
- **When carrying a passenger on a motor cycle make sure that a crush helmet , proper pillion and foot rest is provided**
- **A motor cycle has the right to use the whole of left lane**
- **A motor cycle must travel on the center or middle of the left lane be it in rural areas or urban areas**
- **When overtaking a motor cycle you should give a motor cyclist room because he or she can be blown by the wind towards you**
- **If a motor cycle has an engine capacity of 350 cc must be fitted with crush bars**
- **A velosolex does not carry passengers**

For class 5

- **At the age of 18 years a person can be given a tractors permit- this permit is only valid when you drive tractors only not any other type of vehicle. A tractor is not allowed to carry passengers even on farm business. When you are going for a test you go alone.**
- **A holder of class 5 drivers license does not only drive tractors alone but also drives earth moving machines and construction vehicles.**

SPEED

Vehicle type Maximum km/r	type of road
Heavy vehicles	
80	**Wide tar road**
“	**“**
60	**urban areas**
Light motor vehicle	
120	**Wide tar road**
“	**“**
60	**urban areas**

General speed limit is 60 km/r

Nb: if you are a leaner you are not allowed to carry passengers

Stay off the road if you are drunk, sleepy or emotionally unstable

REQUIREMENTS FOR A VEHICLE TO BE USED ON ROADS

- Every vehicle to be used on Zimbabwean roads it must be registered ,licensed and insured
- Every vehicle must have 2 breakdown triangles placed within 30 - 50 meters from the nearest point of the breakdown vehicle
- Only a motor cycle can not carry those and does not have a revers gear
- If it’s a driving school vehicle it must have the following documents- certificate of fitness and vehicle insurance
- other vehicles must be registered ,licensed and insured
- A leaners vehicle must have a red on white “L-plate” displayed at the back and front of the vehicle
- A private vehicle has black on yellow background number plates and a public has red on white background number plate
- Every vehicle must be fitted with safety belts
- A truck must not tow more than 3 trailers
- A truck towing trailers must have safety chains fitted
- Every towed trailer must have a reflective white “T” on front and at the back
- All Vehicles should have reflectors of white at the front and red at the back for heavy vehicles must add yellow reflectors on the side
- A truck towing 2 trailers must have 6 breakdown triangles for a trailer is an independent car

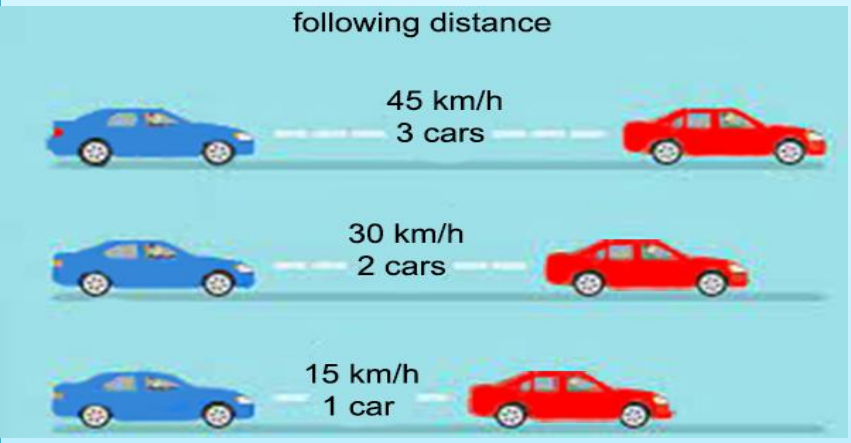
SAFETY BELTS

- Every person in a motor vehicle must put on safety belts when ever they are in a vehicle, with medical exemptions can be allowed not to pu on seat belts.
- The only person exempted from putting on a seat belt is a driver when he or she is reversing or a person with medical exemptions
- An instructor or an ambulance driver is also exempted from putting on a safety belt when conducting lessons or on duty

FOLLOWING,REACTION, BRAKING AND STOPPING DISTANCES

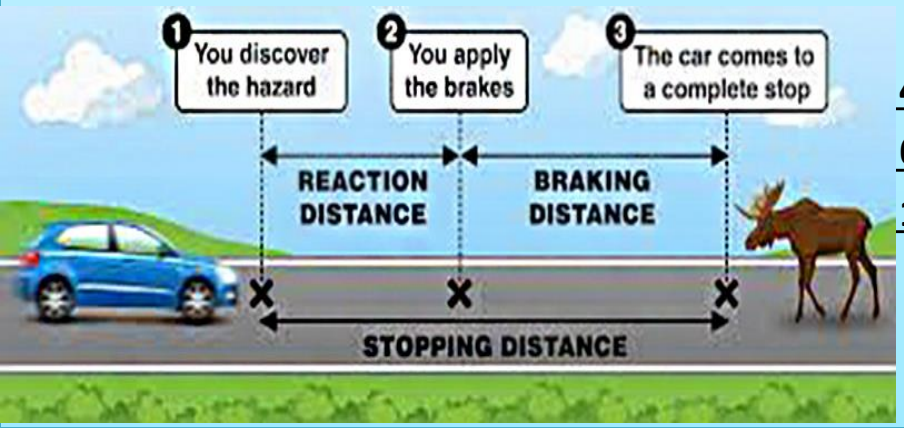
- This is the distance that you leave when you are driving behind another vehicle
- The reason why there must be a safe following distance is in the event that the car in front of you suddenly stops or a pedestrian suddenly jumps on to the road it gives you enough time to stop without endangering your vehicle ,person in front of you.

Following distance



= Simply divide by 15 depending with the amount of speed to get your following distance e.g at 75km/h you leave a gap of 5 cars.

Reaction, breaking and stoping distance



km/h	Reaction	breaking	stopping
40 km/h	5.6 m	12.4 m	18 m
60 km/h	8.3 m	27.7 m	36 m
120 km/h	16.7 m	113.3 m	130m

PRE-CAUTIONS BEFORE SETTING VEHICLE IN MOTION

- Never set your vehicle in motion until you have checked right round and underneath your car for children and pets.
- If you are reversing from a parking slot into a road make sure you have checked all you your mirrors, if you are not sure you get out of your vehicle and check behind you vehicle then proceed if you are sure
- A person under the age of 10 is not allowed at the back of a truck without an adult supervision
- Check you mirror and adjust the if possible, on a mirror there is a blind spot ,this is an area which is not covered by the mirrors
- If you are towing a trailer or caravan and you can not see what is behind you vehicle the l says you use outside mirrors which are the extended arm side mirrors
- In rainy seasons always make sure that you vehicle must be fitted with good tires

Vehicle controls

- Steering – a steering must not have more than 45 degrees of free play, if it exceeds that it becomes a faulty steering
- A Steering backlash not to exceed 12,5% of steering wheel circumference
- Hand break/ park break- used to keep the vehicles stationary
- Clutch- used when changing gears and it reduces the noise when changing gears
- Sun visors – these are used for protection against sun glare Nb. Not all vehicles are supposed to have sun visors e.g. motorcycle can not have a sun visor

EMERGENCIES, TIPS & ACTIONS

- A horn is used in emergencies to warn other road users and in the case of brake fails you are to use the horn to alert other drivers of your situation.
- Any accident must be reported to the police within 24 hrs. ,be it minor
- If you see a person being knocked unconscious you must first check for clear breathing and the rest follows
- When meeting state motorcade ,police, ambulance , fire engine flashing or sounding its device you move out of its course and stop
- When you see a breakdown towing vehicle approaching you must slow down and exercise extreme cautions
- remember when approaching a pedestrian crossing prepare to stop regardless that there are no pedestrians
- All vehicles carrying a load which exceeds normal should be labeled abnormal load vehicles
- All abnormal vehicles must has escort vehicles and the escort vehicles must have a flashing amber beacon
- If you run over a dog you stop and try to look for its owner
- Always remember that when there is low visibility or when you can not see clearly on the road always increase the following distance, when there is fog we use fog lights
- Never attempt to cross a flooded bridge
- Never disembark on a bus whilst still in motion and always wait for the bus to leave then cross for it is dangerous to cross in front of a stationary vehicle as you view on the road would be obstructed
- In case of a rear wheel tire burst Avoid braking completely and control the steering wheel
- When a vehicle starts skidding you must release brakes
- When driving behind a heavy box body goods vehicle, avoid following closely so as to allow safe overtaking and to be visible also
- Never use your cellphone when driving
- When you come across stray animals on the road, You drive past slowly and give them plenty of room
- When turning either to the left or right always check for blind spot ,it is a portion or area not covered by the mirrors
- When you see a wild animal crossing the road in the rural areas, you reduce speed and stop when necessary
- When ever you are driving always read or see the traffic situation in advance(hazard perception)
- A motor vehicle may tow a vehicle only if it has good brakes
- In rainy weather always avoid high speeds because the roads will be slippery you might be involved in an accident.
- When there is fog we use fog lights

DRIVING ON THE ROADS

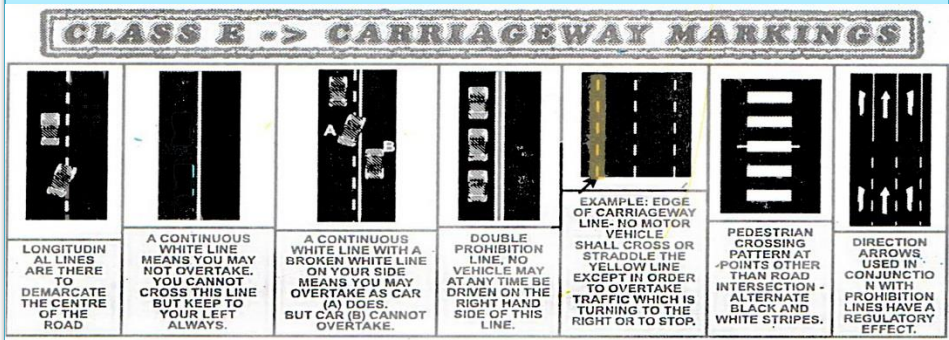
Intersections, road and parking:

- Always remember that during rainy seasons you need to have good tires because roads will be slippery hence there will be a need of good tires for grip on the roads
- When driving a vehicle You are not allowed to park at a corner or intersection not less than 7,5 meters
- When ever you are getting on a road from a parking slot make sure you have checked your mirrors and blind spot before you move
- Always keep to the left side of the road and when overtaking always use the right side of the road unless you are overtaking an animal drawn wagon or vehicle which is turning to the right.
- When making a right turn always go to the extreme right of the left lane
- When making a left turn go to the extreme left of the left lane
- Always remember that when going downhill or uphill engage into lower gears so as to facilitate easy movement.
- Remember always that when ever you are approaching a curve ,bridge , tunnel ,uphill or down hill , approach with a safe speed
- Also in a straight ahead lane you are not allowed to change course or to turn at all because continuous white lines will be on the road
- Never cross a continuous white line on your right side for these are prohibition lines and prohibition line have a regulatory effect. They have a command of law , Road markings with stop lines or transvers lines also have regulatory effect so you must comply and failing to do so you might be arrested
- Never overtake at places where you can not see what is in front of you e.g. tunnels, narrow bridges or even blind rises
- When ever you want to change lane ,turn or overtake make sure that you check your mirrors first then blind spot and lastly indicate. The rest follows
- When you are driving on the highway or main road you indicate 100 meters before you turn and when you are driving in an ordinary city or location its 50 meters before you turn.
- You are not allowed to overtake at an intersection its an offence
- When driving you may overtake another vehicle if there is a broken white line on your right side.
- When driving on areas such as bridges, tunnels and tunnels you need to be on the look out for height , width and weight restrictions for that's what is considered on such places .
- Never are you allowed to take phone calls when you are driving
- When parking your vehicle at a steep decent always make sure that you engage into revers gear and put your hand break on
- When parked on an uphill when there is a curb you lock your wheels to the right and if there is no curb lock your wheels to the left

NIGHT DRIVING

- The law states that lights of a vehicle must be on from 5:30 pm – 6:30am.
- When ever you are driving you must dip your headlights when you drive in a well lit street , when you are driving behind another vehicle(because light will be reflecting straight to the eyes of the driver of the vehicle which is at your front) ,when you are facing an oncoming traffic or a police officer at a road block.
- Every heavy vehicle must have height markers
- A vehicle with headlights which does not reflect the approximate width of the vehicle must have side lights
- When meeting an oncoming vehicle and your view is being destructed by lights of an oncoming car, you must slow down and stop if possible
- When parked at a ,rest place or lay-bye at night you must put on your park lights on

- ROAD MARKINGS
- These are lines which are found on the road surface and also known as carriage way markings.
- These lines have a regulatory effect when there are in conjunction with prohibition lines
- We have different types of lines
- A stop line at an intersection has the same effect as a stop line on a pedestrian crossing
- i) Transverse line/stop line- this line is found at an intersection or at a pedestrian crossing, any vehicle that stops must stop before the line. The law says if you overshoot a transverse line you stay where you are.
- ii) Converging lines – these are two lines which becomes one
- iii) Diverging line- one line which forms two
- Brocken white line – this line maybe crossed when it is on your right side for the purposes of overtaking only
- Continuers white line –this line must not be crossed or straddled at any given time
- Yellow line- this line maybe crossed or straddled only overtaking a vehicle turning to the right



INTERSECTIONS

Intersection is a point where two or more roads meet.

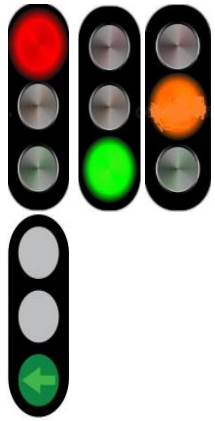
We have 2 types of intersections

i) Controlled intersections:

- **At a controlled intersection is an intersection which is controlled by traffic signs , police officer ,stop lines or traffic lights**
- **At a controlled intersection you must follow given instructions**
- **When ever you are turning to the left at a controlled intersection always give way to pedestrians**

Traffic lights

- Robots at an intersection have a sequence
- **Red (stop) Green (proceed/go) Amber (prepare to stop)**
- **Green Amber Red**
- **Amber Red Green**
- **At a flashing amber robot you give right of way to vehicle aproaching from the road on your right side.**
- **The only time you are allowed to pass through a red robot is when it is controlled by a police or when there is a green arrow filter pointing towards your direction of travell.**



ii) Uncontrolled intersections

- **These intersections are governed by 6 main rules**
- **You come up with an answer after applying several rules to come up with one answer**
- **If asked of a car which will be breaking the law it simply means that you have to identify the car that when it moves it will be going against the rules of uncontrolled intersections or a car that disrupts the right of way of other vehicles**

1) Rule No1 says always give right of way to vehicles approaching from the road on your right side.

- **On this rule when solving questions concerning this we find our solution by going anti-clockwise direction on a car diagram**
- **On this diagram if we start on car A we see that car A has car B on the road on its right side, car B also has car C on the road on its right side ,lastly car C has nothing on the road on its right side meaning to say car C has the right of way**

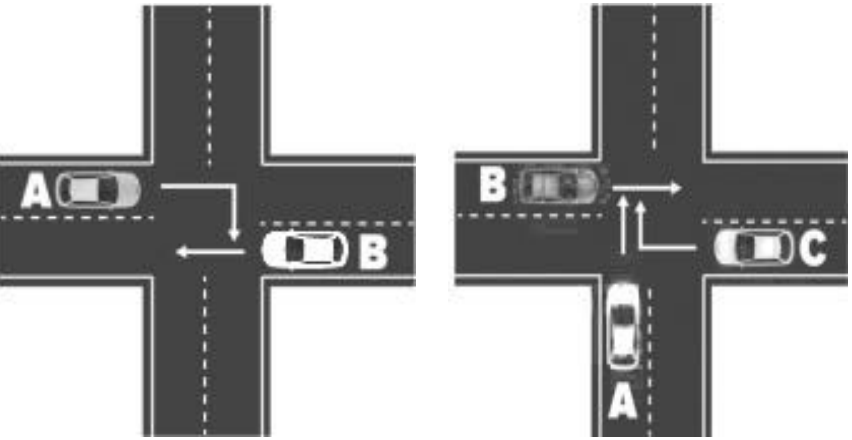


- **NB a car that has nothing on the road on its right side is the vehicle that has right of way always and it is the first one to MOVE or GO**

RULE No2&3

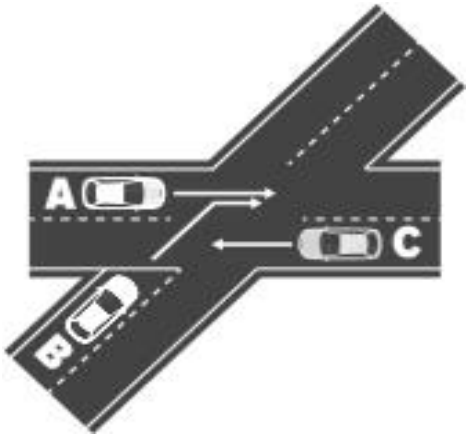
- This rule says that “no car is allowed to turn right in front of an on-coming vehicle”
- This rule works hand in hand with the rule that says “any car that has nothing on its right can move to the center of the road”

- So in this diagram we see that car C has the right of way or nothing on the road from the right side but however car C wants to turn right in front of car B(*never turn right in front of oncoming car*) ***so car C moves to the center and waits there ,therefor blocking car A, car B takes advantage of that so in this case ,car C moves first , car B GOES first and car A goes last***



RULE No4

- Cars in the same road moves together at the same time on the condition that neither of the vehicles is turning to the right or has no sign on its side.
- In this diagram we see that we have car A ,car C and car B but only car A and car C are in the same road and neither of them is turning to the right and has no sign on its side therefore car A and car C moves together and car b going last because car B will be breaking the law if it moves.

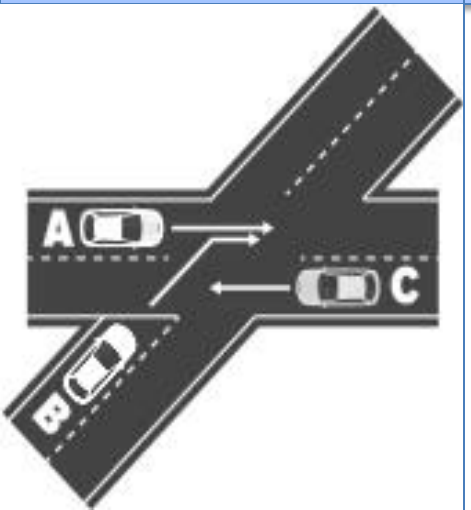


RULE No 5

- Any car that has sign e.g. stop sign or give way sign on its side is the last car to go
- A sign can be a physical sign on the side of the road or road markings sign drawn on the road surface

STOP LINE ON THE ROAD

Car b is the last to go and Breaking the law on both diagrams



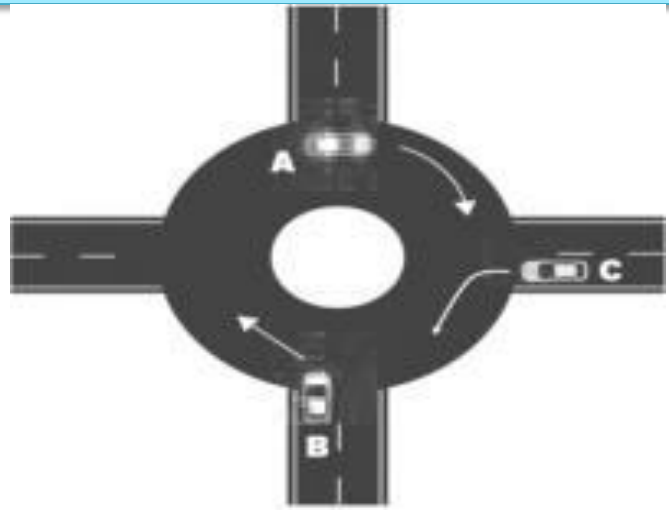
GIVE WAY SING



RULE No 6

- Always give way to vehicles which is already in circulation in traffic circles and always indicate when going out of the traffic circle
- In Zimbabwe vehicles at roundabouts they move in a clock wise direction

Car B is the last to go….A first C second and B last



"Y" INTERSECTIONS

- This type of intersection is different from all other intersections
- From the shape that's where the name came from

1

3



2

Car A on the road labeled 1 is the first car to go followed by car B and lastly car C

In simple terms its any car that is on the road labeled 1 is the first to go if it has no sing on its side followed by the one on road labeled 2 then lastly the car on the road labeled 3

ROAD SIGNS

- In Zimbabwe we have 5 classes of road signs which are

i) Danger warning and warning signs

- The insignia of a warning sign is a triangle
- If you ignore a danger warning sign you maybe involved in an accident
- These signs warns you of danger ahead and there are usually seen 100m before the danger

Examples of danger warning sings



Hump ahead



slow down and expect to be stopped



physical barrier ahead



stop or give way ahead



road narrows to the left



steep decent (engage to lower gears)



width restriction

Examples of warning signs



Hump or ridge ahead



loses stones ahead



temporary accident ahead sign



warning of cyclist ahead



slipery road surface



reduced visibility ahead



vehicle length restriction



traffic lights out of order



Dual way ahead



wild animals



domestic animals



congestion



cross road



end of tarred road



general caution



traffic lights

ii) ***REGULATORY***

- These signs are identified with a circle shape
- Upon seeing these sings you must comply and follow the given instructions for they have a command of law upon them
- These signs work hand in hand with road markings

examples





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INFORMATIVE OR DIRECTION SIGNS

- These signs are there to inform you of the locations you are in or where you want to go
- They have a rectangle shape except for 2 signs which are different from others

EXAMPLES



Direction sign





Informative sign (weight de-restriction)



informative sign (speed de-restriction) exceed the previous speed limit



lane temporarily narrows to the center



Dual carriage freeway



single carriage freeway

Sports stadium

